

Mistakes Make You Grow



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Title Page

Mistakes Make You Grow

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Dedication

To every child learning, trying, and growing each day.
May you always see mistakes as stepping stones to something amazing, and may your courage to try again grow bigger every time.

Anote To Parents and Teachers

Greetings,

Parents and Teachers

Children's mistakes are not failures—they are important steps in learning and growing. When a child spills, trips, or gets something wrong, it might look messy or frustrating, but these moments are full of opportunities. Each mistake helps children practice problem-solving, patience, courage, and creativity.

This book is designed to help children understand that mistakes are normal, expected, and helpful. It teaches them that being wrong is not bad—it is a chance to learn, try again, and grow stronger.

As a parent or teacher, your role is very important. You can:

1. Encourage effort, not just results – Praise trying, practicing, and learning, even if the first attempt doesn't work.
2. Model how to handle mistakes – Show your child how you try again when something doesn't go as planned.
3. Talk about feelings – Help children name their feelings of frustration, embarrassment, or worry, and guide them to respond calmly.

4. Celebrate small successes – Every step forward, even after a mistake, is worth noticing and celebrating.

With your support, children can see mistakes as stepping stones, gain confidence, and develop a mindset that helps them become brave, curious, and resilient learners.

Part I: Understanding Mistakes

Chapter 1: What Is a Mistake?

A mistake happens when we try to do something, but it doesn't turn out the way we wanted. Maybe you spilled your juice, dropped your blocks, or colored outside the lines. Sometimes mistakes feel small, like a little oops, and sometimes they feel big, like a huge mess. But the truth is that everyone makes mistakes—kids, parents, teachers, and even superheroes! Mistakes are not signs that we are bad or silly; they are signs that we are learning, growing, and trying new things.

Mistakes are like secret teachers. They show us what doesn't work so we can figure out what does. When you tie your shoelaces for the first time, you might tie them too tight or too loose. When you try to draw a cat, its ears might look like triangles that don't match. These mistakes might make you laugh, frown, or feel frustrated, and that is okay. Every time you notice a mistake, you are practicing patience, focus, and problem-solving, even if it doesn't feel like it at first.

Sometimes mistakes make us feel worried, angry, or even a little embarrassed. That's normal too! Your feelings are like little helpers telling you that something didn't go the way you wanted. You can take a deep breath, smile, and say to yourself, "It's

okay, I'm learning. I can try again." Every time you do this, your courage and confidence grow a little bigger. Mistakes help you understand that it is okay to not be perfect, and that trying and learning is the most important part.

Think about it this way: every time you make a mistake, your brain is stretching, practicing, and getting stronger. Mistakes are part of the adventure of learning new things, discovering new skills, and becoming braver. You can even start to look forward to mistakes because they are little clues showing where you can grow. And the best part? When you try again, you will feel proud, happy, and ready to try even more new things.

Try this today: Think about one small mistake you made recently. Maybe you spilled your juice or colored outside the lines. Close your eyes, remember it, and then say out loud: "I made a mistake, and I learned something!" Notice how it makes you feel. That feeling is the start of your growth superpower.

Chapter 2: Why Mistakes Are Good

Mistakes are not just okay—they are actually really helpful! Every mistake you make is like a little treasure chest full of lessons. When something doesn't go the way you planned, your brain notices it and starts thinking about what to do next. Maybe your tower of blocks fell down, or you wrote a letter backwards.

Even though it might feel frustrating at first, these moments help your brain learn how to do better next time. Mistakes are like tiny teachers, showing you what works and what doesn't.

Making mistakes can help you get smarter and stronger. Imagine trying to draw a picture of a rainbow. At first, your colors might mix together or go outside the lines. You might feel disappointed. But the next time, you remember what happened, and you try again. Your rainbow gets brighter, neater, and more beautiful. That's how mistakes help you grow. Every time you try again, your brain practices, your hands get steadier, and your ideas get better.

Mistakes also help you be brave. When you try something new, like reading a big word or learning to ride a bike, there is a chance you will make mistakes. That's okay! Each mistake is a sign that you are being courageous, because you are trying something that feels tricky. The more mistakes you make and learn from, the more confident you become. You start to understand that being wrong is not scary—it is part of being brave and learning.

Another wonderful thing about mistakes is that they teach you patience and kindness. Sometimes, mistakes take time to fix, and that is okay. When you spill your juice, you can clean it up slowly. When a block tower falls, you can build it again carefully. Mistakes remind you that it is okay to slow down, take a breath, and try again. They also help you be kind to others, because

everyone makes mistakes. When your friend drops their blocks, you can help them instead of laughing. Kindness and understanding grow from noticing that everyone learns by trying and making mistakes.

Try this today: Think of one mistake you made recently. Ask yourself, “What can I learn from this?” Draw a picture or tell a story about it. Then, think about one thing you can do differently next time. Remember, mistakes are your secret helpers—they help you grow, get better, and become stronger and smarter every single day.

Chapter 3: It’s Okay to Be Wrong

Being wrong is a normal part of learning, and it happens to everyone—even grown-ups! Sometimes your answer might be different from what your teacher or friend expects. Maybe you counted the blocks one too many times, or drew a circle instead of a square. That does not mean you are bad or not smart. It just means you are trying, exploring, and learning new things. Being wrong is a sign that your brain is working and stretching.

When you are wrong, your brain gets a chance to figure out a better way. Every time you notice a mistake, pause, and ask yourself, “What can I do differently next time?” you are

practicing problem-solving and growing stronger. Imagine trying to stack a block tower, and it tumbles down. Instead of giving up, you notice how it fell and build it again in a better way. That is how being wrong helps you learn and improve.

It's okay to feel a little frustrated or embarrassed when you are wrong. These feelings are normal, and they help you pay attention to what is happening. You can take a deep breath, say, "It's okay, I can try again," and then keep going. Every time you do this, your confidence grows. You learn that making mistakes does not stop you from being smart, kind, or capable—it actually helps you become even better at what you are trying to do.

Being wrong also helps you understand others. Everyone makes mistakes, so when your friend gets a math problem wrong or spills their drink, you can remember that it is okay. You can help, encourage, or even laugh together. Being kind when someone else is wrong helps you grow empathy and friendship, and it makes learning more fun for everyone.

Try this today: Think of something you did recently that didn't go right. Maybe you drew a picture differently than you wanted, or your blocks fell down. Close your eyes and say, "It's okay to be wrong. I am learning." Then try again and notice how your brain and hands get stronger with every attempt. Remember, being wrong is one of the best ways to learn, grow, and become even smarter and braver!

Part II: Mistakes at Home

Chapter 4: Oops! I Spilled Something

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Sometimes, accidents happen. Maybe your juice tumbles off the table, your paint splashes on the floor, or your block tower falls over. When this happens, it can feel a little frustrating or even embarrassing. But guess what? Spills and accidents are a type of mistake, and they are totally normal! Every child—and every grown-up—has these moments. They are not signs that you are careless or bad. They are just opportunities to learn and try again.

When you spill something, the first step is to take a deep breath. Feeling upset is okay, and noticing your feelings helps you calm down. You can say to yourself, “Oops! That happened. What can I do next?” This gives your brain a chance to think clearly and figure out how to fix the mistake. Maybe you grab a cloth to clean up the juice, or ask a grown-up to help. Each time you handle a spill calmly, your problem-solving skills get stronger, and your confidence grows.

Accidents like spills also teach you to be patient and gentle. Cleaning up can take time, and that’s okay. You might need to wipe the table slowly or pick up little drops one by one. Doing this carefully helps you practice focus and care. You may even

discover that cleaning up a spill can be fun! You might pretend your cloth is a magic wand that makes the floor shiny again, turning a mistake into a playful learning adventure.

Spills also remind us to be kind to others. If your friend spills something, you can offer to help instead of getting upset or laughing. Helping each other makes your home a friendly, caring place, and it shows that mistakes are normal for everyone. Everyone learns from accidents, and everyone grows when they are patient, thoughtful, and brave enough to try again.

Try this today: Think of a small accident you had recently. Maybe you knocked over a cup or dropped a toy. Draw a picture of it, then write or say how you fixed it, cleaned it up, or tried again. Notice how handling the mistake made you feel proud, calm, and smart. Remember, accidents are part of learning, and every spill is a chance to grow your superpower of trying again.

Chapter 5: Learning New Skills

Learning new skills can feel exciting, but it can also feel tricky. Maybe you are trying to tie your shoelaces, pour your own juice, or ride a bike without training wheels. When you try something for the first time, it is normal to make mistakes. Your laces might

get tangled, your juice might spill, or you might wobble on your bike. These mistakes do not mean you are not good at it—they mean you are practicing, exploring, and learning. Every mistake is part of the journey to becoming better.

Trying new skills teaches you patience and perseverance. Sometimes it takes many tries before your hands and brain work together perfectly. Your brain is learning how to guide your fingers, your eyes, and your balance. Every time you try again, your brain and body get stronger. It's like planting seeds: each attempt is a drop of water that helps your skill grow bigger and stronger. And just like a plant, your new skill will take time to bloom—but every small step counts!

Learning new skills also teaches you to celebrate progress, not just the end result. Maybe today you tied one loop of your shoelace, poured most of your juice without spilling, or pedaled halfway down the path before wobbling. These are victories, even if it's not perfect yet. Saying, "I did a little better today!" helps your brain feel proud and keeps you excited to try again. Mistakes and small wins together make learning fun, exciting, and rewarding.

Another wonderful part of learning new skills is sharing and helping others. When your brother or sister is learning something new, you can cheer them on or show them what you learned. When you make a mistake and try again, you are teaching others that it's okay to be imperfect and brave.

Learning together and supporting each other makes the experience happier for everyone.

Try this today: Pick one new skill you want to practice, like drawing, pouring, or tying your shoes. Notice what is tricky, and then try it again slowly and carefully. Even if you make mistakes, smile, and say, “I am learning! I will try again!” Every time you practice, you grow smarter, stronger, and braver. Remember, mistakes are your stepping stones, and trying is your superpower.

Chapter 6: Helping Each Other Learn

Learning is even more fun when we help each other. Sometimes your friend might be trying to tie their shoes, count numbers, or draw a picture, and they make a mistake. Instead of laughing or pointing out their mistake, you can offer a helping hand, a kind word, or a gentle smile. Helping others not only makes them feel brave and happy, but it also teaches you patience, kindness, and understanding.

When you help someone learn, you become a little teacher yourself. You can show them how to do something step by step, or simply cheer them on: “You can do it! Try again!” Even if your friend makes mistakes, your encouragement helps them feel

strong and confident. You can remember your own mistakes, and how nice it felt when someone helped you without judging. Helping each other is a way to practice teamwork, empathy, and courage, all at the same time.

Sometimes helping others means being patient. Maybe your friend doesn't understand something right away, or keeps making the same mistake. That's okay! You can take a deep breath and say, "It's okay. Let's try again together." Each time you do this, both you and your friend are learning an important lesson: mistakes are normal, and trying together makes learning easier and more fun.

Helping each other also helps you think in new ways. When you explain how to do something, your brain practices the skill too. You might notice something you never thought about before. Maybe you find a better way to tie your shoes or pour juice without spilling. Helping others teaches you that learning is not just about yourself—it's about growing together and sharing your superpowers.

Try this today: Think of one friend or family member you can help when they make a mistake. It could be helping your sibling build a block tower, showing a friend how to draw a shape, or cheering someone on while they try a new skill. Notice how helping them makes you feel proud and kind. Remember, when we help each other learn, everyone's mistakes become chances to grow together.

Part III: Mistakes at School

Chapter 7: Raising Your Hand

Being brave at school often starts with a small action: raising your hand. Sometimes, you might know an answer, have a question, or want to share an idea—but your brain whispers, “What if I’m wrong?” That’s when mistakes can feel scary. But raising your hand shows that you are brave, curious, and ready to learn. Even if your answer isn’t perfect, you are practicing courage, and that is more important than being right the first time.

When you raise your hand, you are giving yourself a chance to try, learn, and grow. You might answer correctly, or you might make a small mistake. That’s okay! Each time you speak up, your brain practices thinking, your heart practices confidence, and your voice practices sharing your ideas. Mistakes in these moments are not failures—they are part of learning how to be brave and smart in school.

Raising your hand also teaches you about patience and respect. You wait your turn, listen to your classmates, and show that everyone’s voice matters. Even when you make a mistake, your teacher or friends can help you understand what to do next. Each correction is another step to learning, and each small effort builds your courage. You begin to see that trying is more

important than being perfect.

Helping others feel brave is another part of raising your hand. When your friend is shy or unsure, you can encourage them: “You can do it! Try answering!” This helps your whole class grow together. Mistakes don’t make you less smart—they make your brain stronger, braver, and ready for the next challenge.

Try this today: Think of one time you felt nervous to answer a question at school. Take a deep breath, raise your hand next time, and say what’s in your mind. Notice how proud you feel, even if you make a small mistake. Remember, every hand you raise is a step toward learning, growing, and being braver each day.

Chapter 8: Reading, Writing, and Counting

Learning to read, write, and count is full of chances to make mistakes—and that is a very good thing! When you try to sound out a new word, write your name, or add numbers together, you might get some answers wrong at first. Maybe a letter looks backwards, a number is mixed up, or a word doesn’t sound right. That does not mean you are not smart. It means you are practicing, learning, and growing. Every mistake is like a stepping stone to understanding better next time.

Mistakes in reading, writing, and counting help your brain learn how to think, remember, and try again. If you miscount the blocks, you can start over and notice where you went off. If you spell a word incorrectly, you can sound it out again or ask for help. Each small correction teaches your brain new ways to solve problems and remember patterns. That is how learning works: by trying, making mistakes, and trying again until it clicks.

Being patient with yourself is very important. Some days, reading a sentence might feel tricky, or writing a word might take a long time. That is perfectly okay! You can take a deep breath, smile, and say, “I am learning! I can try again.” Your brain will remember the steps, and slowly, what once felt hard will become easier and easier. Mistakes are not obstacles—they are teachers that help you grow smarter and stronger.

Sharing and learning with friends can make mistakes even more fun. Maybe your friend shows you a new way to count, or you read a story together and help each other with tricky words. When you laugh at small mistakes, help each other, and try again together, learning becomes exciting. You see that everyone makes mistakes, and that everyone can grow and get better.

Try this today: Pick one reading, writing, or counting activity.

Notice if you make a mistake. Then, take a deep breath, try again, and see what you learn. Smile at yourself for trying! Remember, every mistake you make helps your brain grow, your courage grow, and your learning superpower grow too.

Chapter 9: Sharing and Playing Together

Playing with friends is one of the best ways to learn, but sometimes mistakes happen during play. Maybe someone takes a toy you were using, or you knock over a block tower by accident. These moments can feel frustrating, but they are also chances to practice patience, kindness, and teamwork. Mistakes in play teach you how to share, how to wait your turn, and how to solve little problems together.

When you make a mistake while playing, like bumping into a friend or dropping something, it's okay to say, "Oops! I didn't mean to." Saying sorry and trying again shows that you care about your friends and helps everyone feel happy and safe. Your mistakes do not make you a bad friend—they help you learn how to play fair, take turns, and be gentle. Every time you handle a mistake well, you are growing your friendship skills and your courage.

Playing together also means noticing when your friends make mistakes. Maybe your friend accidentally breaks a tower or

colors outside the lines. Instead of laughing or getting upset, you can say, “It’s okay! Let’s try again together!” Helping your friends when they make mistakes teaches empathy, patience, and teamwork. You begin to understand that everyone learns from mistakes, and helping each other makes playtime more fun and less stressful.

Mistakes during play also teach problem-solving. When the blocks fall, you can figure out a new way to build them. When a game doesn’t go as planned, you can think of a new rule or plan together. These little mistakes help your brain practice thinking creatively and trying new ideas, which makes learning and playing exciting.

Try this today: The next time you play, notice one time you make a small mistake. Say, “I can try again!” or “Oops! Let’s fix it!” Notice how it feels to fix the mistake or help a friend fix theirs. Remember, sharing, playing, and learning from mistakes together makes you a better friend, a braver player, and a stronger learner.

Part IV: When Mistakes Feel Hard

Chapter 10: Feeling Frustrated

Sometimes, making mistakes can feel very frustrating. Maybe you tried to draw a picture, build a tower, or tie your shoes, and it didn't turn out the way you wanted. Your hands might feel wiggly, your tummy might flutter, and your face might frown. These feelings are normal—they happen to everyone! Feeling frustrated is your brain's way of saying, "This is hard, but keep trying." It does not mean you are not good or smart.

When you feel frustrated, the first thing to do is pause and take a deep breath. Breathing slowly helps your heart calm down and your brain think more clearly. You can even say to yourself, "It's okay. I am learning. I can try again." These words are like a superpower shield that helps you feel strong even when mistakes make you feel upset. Frustration is not a stop sign—it is a signal that you are practicing something new and your brain is growing.

Frustration can also teach you patience and problem-solving. Maybe your block tower keeps falling, or your drawing doesn't look like you imagined. Instead of giving up, try looking at it a new way. Could you build the tower differently? Could you add a new color to your drawing? Each small change is a chance to learn something new and feel proud of yourself. Mistakes plus

patience equal super learning!

Another way to handle frustration is to ask for help. Maybe a friend, parent, or teacher can show you a trick you didn't know. Sometimes, watching someone else try or hearing their advice helps your brain see a new path forward. Asking for help is not a mistake—it is bravery, because it shows you want to learn and grow.

Try this today: Think of one thing that frustrated you recently. Take a deep breath, say, "I can try again," and make one small change or ask for help. Notice how your feelings change when you take a calm, brave step. Remember, frustration is a friend that teaches your brain to grow, your heart to be brave, and your mistakes to become lessons.

Chapter 11: Saying Sorry and Forgiving

Sometimes mistakes can hurt other people, even when you didn't mean to. Maybe you knocked over a friend's block tower, spilled their juice, or said something unkind by accident. When this happens, it is brave and kind to say sorry. Saying sorry shows that you notice the mistake, you care about the other person's feelings, and you want to make things better. It is a powerful way to turn a mistake into a chance to grow.

Saying sorry doesn't just help your friend—it helps your heart feel lighter, too. When you apologize, your brain and heart notice that you are taking responsibility for what happened. You might feel a little nervous at first, and that is okay! Being honest and brave about mistakes is part of learning how to be a good friend, a kind classmate, and a thoughtful family member.

Forgiving is just as important as saying sorry. If someone makes a mistake with you, like knocking over your blocks or saying something mean, you can choose to forgive them. Forgiving doesn't mean you forget what happened or that it's always okay to hurt someone. It means you let go of anger and give both yourself and your friend a chance to try again, play again, and be kind again. Forgiveness helps everyone feel happier, safer, and more confident to learn and grow.

Mistakes and forgiveness also teach a very important lesson: everyone is learning, including adults. Even grown-ups spill things, forget instructions, or say something by mistake. Watching adults say sorry and forgive each other shows children how to handle mistakes with courage, kindness, and patience. This helps children practice the same skills in their own friendships, schoolwork, and family life.

Try this today: Think of one time you made a small mistake that affected someone else. Take a deep breath and say, "I'm sorry. I will try again." Then, think of one time a friend made a mistake

with you, and try saying, “It’s okay! I forgive you.” Notice how both your heart and your friend’s heart feel lighter and happier. Remember, saying sorry and forgiving are superpowers that turn mistakes into learning, love, and stronger friendships.

Chapter 12: Trying Again Makes You Stronger

Sometimes mistakes feel frustrating, and it can be tempting to give up. Maybe you tried a puzzle and couldn’t finish it, or you spilled your juice when pouring it into a cup. That’s okay! Every time you try again, your brain, your hands, and your heart get stronger. Trying again shows that you are brave, determined, and ready to grow, even when something feels tricky at first.

When you try again, it doesn’t matter if you succeed the first time. What matters is that you did not give up. Each try is practice. Each mistake is a lesson. Every time you start over, you are teaching your brain new ways to solve problems and your heart to be patient and brave. Even tiny steps forward are big victories when you keep going after a mistake.

Sometimes trying again can feel hard. Your brain might say, “I can’t do it!” or your hands might feel tired. That is normal! You can take a deep breath, smile, and remind yourself, “It’s okay. I am learning. I can try again.” These words are like a magic key

that opens the door to success, confidence, and courage. Mistakes are not walls—they are stepping stones to help you grow stronger each day.

Trying again is also about celebrating small wins. Maybe you can tie one shoelace by yourself, or draw part of a picture that used to feel impossible. Each small win is proof that effort counts more than perfection. Over time, all these small victories add up, and you realize that your mistakes were helping you all along. They were teaching your brain, strengthening your hands, and growing your courage.

Try this today: Think of one thing you tried that didn't work out the first time. Take a deep breath, smile, and try again. Notice how it feels to keep going. Celebrate every little step, even if it is not perfect. Remember, trying again makes your brain smarter, your hands stronger, and your heart braver. Each mistake is a lesson, and each lesson is a chance to grow.

Part V: Growing From Mistakes

Chapter 13: Every Mistake Teaches Something

Every mistake you make is a little teacher in disguise. Maybe you spilled your milk, drew outside the lines, or forgot a step in a game. At first, mistakes can feel frustrating, but each one has a special lesson hidden inside. When you notice the lesson, you grow smarter, stronger, and braver with every try. Mistakes are not failures—they are opportunities to learn and improve.

Think of mistakes like seeds. Each time you make one, it is planted in your brain, and every time you try again, it grows a little more. Maybe the seed teaches you how to hold your cup carefully, or how to write a letter neatly, or how to be patient with a friend. You might not see the growth right away, but little by little, the lessons from mistakes help you become a better learner, thinker, and friend.

Mistakes also help you discover new ideas. Sometimes, when something doesn't work the first time, you think of a new way to do it. Maybe your block tower falls, but then you build it in a new way that is even taller. Maybe your drawing spills a little, but you turn it into something creative and fun. Mistakes help your brain try new ways of solving problems, and they make learning exciting.

Every mistake teaches something different, and every lesson helps you grow more confident. You start to realize that making mistakes does not mean you are not good—it means you are learning, exploring, and getting better. When you make a mistake, you can pause and ask, “What can I learn from this?” That simple question helps you see mistakes as superpowers that make your brain and heart stronger.

Try this today: Think of one mistake you made recently. Ask yourself, “What can I learn from this?” Draw a picture or tell a story about it. Notice how even a small mistake can teach something big. Remember, every mistake is a chance to grow smarter, braver, and stronger.

Chapter 14: You Are Learning Every Day

Every single day, you are learning—even when you don’t notice it! Sometimes learning happens when you make a mistake, like spilling your drink or getting a letter wrong. Other times, learning happens when you try something new, like building a tall block tower, drawing a picture, or helping a friend. Every experience, every mistake, and every try helps your brain grow and makes your heart stronger. Learning is happening all the time, and you are part of it every day.

Learning from mistakes is like collecting little treasures. Maybe today you learned how to tie your shoelaces, how to share a toy, or how to fix a small problem on your own. Each lesson, no matter how small, adds up. Some lessons are easy to see right away, like putting away your toys after playing. Others take longer, like learning to be patient or brave when something feels tricky. Every day gives you a chance to practice, notice, and grow.

It is important to remember that learning is not about being perfect. Nobody is perfect—not your friends, your family, or even grown-ups! Learning is about trying, making mistakes, asking for help when needed, and trying again. Each time you do this, you are training your brain to get stronger, smarter, and more creative. Mistakes are not stopping points—they are stepping stones on your journey of learning.

You can notice your learning every day if you pay attention. Maybe you feel proud when you do something better than yesterday. Maybe you smile when you figure out a tricky puzzle or remember a new word. These little moments show that your brain and heart are growing. Even when something feels hard, every try teaches you something valuable. Every day is full of learning, and you are growing more and more every single day!

Try this today: Think of one thing you learned today. Maybe it was big, like tying a shoe, or small, like remembering to say

“thank you.” Draw a picture, tell a story, or share it with a friend or grown-up. Notice how learning makes your brain and heart stronger. Remember, you are learning every day, and every mistake helps you grow!

Chapter 15: Your Growth Superpower

Did you know that mistakes are actually your secret superpower? Every time you make a mistake, try again, or learn something new, your brain and heart grow stronger. This superpower is called “Growth”, and it lives inside you. It helps you become braver, smarter, kinder, and more confident every single day. The more you use it, the bigger and stronger it becomes!

Your growth superpower shows up in many ways. Maybe you spilled your drink but cleaned it up and tried pouring again. Maybe you said the wrong answer in class but raised your hand the next time. Maybe you accidentally knocked over a friend's block tower but helped rebuild it together. Every time you notice a mistake and learn from it, your superpower grows a little more. These small, brave actions are like training your superpower muscles—they get stronger with every try.

Using your growth superpower also means being patient and

kind to yourself. Sometimes learning takes time, and mistakes will happen. That's okay! You can say to yourself, "It's okay to make mistakes. I am learning and growing every day." These words help you remember that mistakes are not something to be afraid of—they are the magic that helps your brain and heart grow.

The best part about your growth superpower is that it never runs out. You can use it at home, at school, when playing with friends, or even when trying something completely new. Every mistake, every try, and every little effort is like fuel for your superpower. The more you practice, the stronger and braver you become. You are capable of amazing things because your mistakes help you learn, grow, and shine.

Try this today: Think of one mistake you made recently. Smile, take a deep breath, and say, "My mistakes help me grow!" Then, do one small thing to try again or learn from it. Notice how proud and strong you feel. Remember, your mistakes are your superpower, and every day gives you a new chance to grow even more!

Back Matter for Mistakes Make You Grow

Mistake Activity Pages

1. Draw a Mistake You Learned From

Think of a mistake you made that taught you something. Maybe you spilled your drink, drew outside the lines, or knocked over a block tower. On this page, draw a picture of that mistake. Show what happened and how you tried again. Add colors, smiles, or even funny faces! This will help you remember that mistakes are not scary—they are teachers in disguise.

2. My Try-Again Journal

Write or tell a story about one thing you tried and didn't get right the first time. What happened? How did you feel? What did you do next? If you can't write yet, draw pictures and ask a grown-up to help label your story with words. Each entry reminds you that every mistake is a chance to grow.

3. Mistake Challenge: Try, Learn, Grow

Try one small brave action every day. You could:

Try a food you have never eaten before

Build something new, even if it's tricky

Ask a question in class, even if you are unsure

Help a friend or family member, even if it feels hard

Each time you do it, notice how your heart and brain feel. Circle or check the day when you complete your challenge. Small steps every day make your growth superpower stronger!

Reflection Questions

Take a moment to think, draw, or tell a grown-up about these questions:

- What mistake taught you something new today?
- How did you feel when you made that mistake?
- What did you do to try again?
- Who helped you when you made a mistake, and how?
- How did you feel after trying again or learning from the mistake?

Reflecting helps your brain notice the lessons, your heart feel proud, and your growth superpower get even stronger.

Growth Promise

Repeat this promise every morning, or whenever you feel unsure or scared:

“I can make mistakes.

I can try again.

I learn something new every time.

Mistakes help me grow!”

Say it quietly in your mind, out loud to yourself, or with a friend or family member. Each time you repeat it, your superpower grows stronger and your courage shines brighter.

For Grown-Ups: Helping Children Learn from Mistakes

1. Encourage effort, not just results

Praise children for trying, practicing, and learning, even if they

make mistakes. Celebrate effort and persistence, not only success.

2. Model learning from mistakes

Share your own “oops” moments and show how you try again. Children learn by seeing adults handle mistakes calmly and positively.

3. Talk about feelings and frustration

Help children name their emotions when they make mistakes. Show strategies for calming down, problem-solving, and trying again.

4. Celebrate trying again

Focus on the courage to start over and the lessons learned. Remind children that every mistake is a step toward growth and confidence.